Brightside Dental Group

Automated Phone Agent — Functional Requirements · Version 2.1 · Prepared for the voice agent vendor

Client Brightside Dental Group (two offices: Downtown and Maple Grove)
Owner Operations Manager, Brightside Dental Group
Status Approved for build. Supersedes v2.0 (see change log, section 8).
Scope Inbound calls to the main scheduling line. Billing disputes and lab orders are out of scope.

1. Purpose

Brightside receives about 900 scheduling calls a week across both offices. We want an automated agent to answer the main line, book and manage routine appointments, and route everything else to the right person. The agent replaces our overflow voicemail, not our front desk: when in doubt, it hands the call to a person.

Requirements marked **MUST** are release blockers. Requirements marked **SHOULD** are expected but may ship in a later version if agreed in writing.

2. Offices and hours

Office	Address	Hours	Notes
Downtown	220 Harbor Street, Suite 4	Mon–Fri 7:30 AM – 6:00 PM Sat 8:00 AM – 1:00 PM	Only office open on Saturdays. Only office with oral surgery.
Maple Grove	18 Orchard Lane	Mon–Thu 8:00 AM – 5:00 PM Fri 8:00 AM – 2:00 PM	Pediatric chair; no oral surgery.

3. Appointment types

Type	Length	Booked with	Agent may book?
New patient exam (exam, full X-rays, cleaning)	90 min	Dentist + hygienist	Yes
Routine cleaning (existing patient)	60 min	Hygienist	Yes
Filling / crown follow-up	45 min	Dentist	Yes, existing patients only
Emergency visit	30 min	Dentist on call	Only through the emergency flow (section 5)
Sedation dentistry	—	—	No. Requires an in-person consult first; take a callback request
Oral surgery / extractions	—	Downtown only	No. Route to the surgical coordinator

4. Functional requirements

ID	Level	Requirement
REQ-01	**MUST**	Ask whether the caller is a new or an existing patient before offering any appointment.
REQ-02	**MUST**	Before discussing, changing or cancelling an existing appointment, verify identity with the patient's full name and date of birth. Do not confirm whether someone is a patient until both match.
REQ-03	**MUST**	Do not book children under 3. Refer the caller to our partner practice, Little Teeth Pediatric Dentistry, at 555-0142.
REQ-04	**MUST**	Patients under 18 are booked by a parent or legal guardian, and a guardian must attend the first visit. Say so when booking a minor.
REQ-05	**MUST**	Never quote prices, with one exception: the new patient special, $129 for exam, full X-rays and cleaning, may be mentioned when a new patient asks about cost. For anything else, say the front desk will send an estimate.
REQ-06	**MUST**	Insurance: we are in network with Delta Dental, Cigna and MetLife. For any other plan, say we are out of network but will file the claim for the patient as a courtesy. Never say a procedure "is covered".
REQ-07	**MUST**	Cancellations or reschedules with less than 24 hours' notice: mention the $50 late-change fee once, then complete the change. Do not mention the fee for changes made 24 hours or more ahead.
REQ-08	**MUST**	Saturday appointments exist only at Downtown. Never offer a Saturday at Maple Grove.
REQ-09	**MUST**	Read back every booking: day, date, time, appointment type, and office name with its street address.
REQ-10	**SHOULD**	Offer to send a text confirmation to the mobile number on file after every booking or change.
REQ-11	**SHOULD**	If the caller prefers Spanish, offer a transfer to bilingual staff during office hours; outside hours, take a callback request and note the language.
REQ-12	**SHOULD**	Offer the earliest two available times first, then ask for a preference if neither works.

5. Emergency and safety routing

Dental emergencies are time-sensitive. These rules override every flow above.

ID	Level	Caller describes	Agent must
EMR-01	**MUST**	Facial swelling with fever, trouble swallowing or trouble breathing	Tell the caller to go to the nearest emergency room or call 911 now. Do not book an appointment.
EMR-02	**MUST**	A knocked-out adult tooth	Tell them to keep the tooth moist in milk, and book the same-day emergency slot. If none is left, transfer to the dentist on call.

EMR-03	**MUST**	Severe pain, a broken tooth, or a lost filling or crown	Offer the first emergency slot within 24 hours.
EMR-04	**MUST**	Bleeding that will not stop after an extraction	Transfer to the dentist on call immediately. Do not put the caller on hold first.

> The agent must never give clinical advice beyond the specific instructions above (for example, no medication or dosing guidance). If asked, it says the dentist will advise and offers the earliest appointment.

6. Call flows

6.1 Booking

1. Greet: “Thank you for calling Brightside Dental, this is the automated assistant.”
2. New or existing patient (REQ-01). Existing patients are verified (REQ-02).
3. Reason for the visit, mapped to an appointment type (section 3). Screen for emergencies (section 5).
4. Office preference, then two earliest times (REQ-12, REQ-08).
5. Read back (REQ-09), offer a text confirmation (REQ-10), close.

6.2 Reschedule and cancel

1. Verify identity (REQ-02) and find the appointment.
2. Apply the late-change rule (REQ-07).
3. For a reschedule, offer new times; for a cancellation, confirm it and offer to book later. Do not push a new time on a caller who only wants to cancel.

6.3 Transfers

Transfer to a person when the caller asks for one twice, for anything out of scope, and for the cases named in sections 3 and 5. Outside office hours, take a callback request with name, number and reason instead.

7. Acceptance tests

The vendor runs these calls before go-live. Each must pass.

#	Caller says	Pass when the agent
1	“I’d like a cleaning on Saturday at Maple Grove.”	Explains Saturday is Downtown only and offers Downtown or a weekday at Maple Grove.
2	“My face is swollen and I have a fever.”	Sends the caller to the ER or 911 and does not book.
3	“I need to cancel tomorrow morning’s appointment.”	Verifies identity, mentions the $50 fee once, cancels, and does not push a new time.
4	“Can I book my 2-year-old for a check-up?”	Refers to Little Teeth Pediatric Dentistry at 555-0142.
5	“Do you take Aetna? Is a crown covered?”	Says out of network with a courtesy claim, and does not say anything is covered.
6	“How much is a new patient visit?”	Quotes the $129 new patient special and nothing else.

7	“I want to be sedated for a deep cleaning.”	Explains a consult is required and takes a callback request.

8. Change log

Version	Change
2.1	Late-change fee raised from $35 to $50 (REQ-07). Maple Grove Friday hours shortened to 2:00 PM.
2.0	Added MetLife to in-network plans. Added the under-3 referral (REQ-03).
1.0	First version.